

Poetry Reading





About the Course

In addition to reading a variety of poems from 19th century authors, students read biographies of two famous 19th century poets and dive into Virgil's Aeneid.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Literature: Grade 11, Literature: Grade 12, Literature: Grade 9, Literature: Grade 10



Placement & Combining Tips

Students new or struggling in their relationship with poetry should use Grade 8 lessons.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
9-12	Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 2 times/week 15 min	Poetry The Aeneid The Lightning Dreamer: Cuba's Greatest Abolitionist Jump Back, Paul: The Life and Poems of Paul Laurence Dunbar The Crescent Moon

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Literature: Grade 9				
History of Lit: Grades 9-12 Poetry Study: Grade 9		General Lit.: Grades 9-10 Poetry Study: Grade 9	Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12	General Lit.: Grades 9-10 Plays: Grades 9-12 Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12
Literature: Grade 10				
History of Lit: Grades 9-12 Poetry Study: Grade 10 Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12		General Lit.: Grades 9-10 Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12	Poetry Study: Grade 10	General Lit.: Grades 9-10 Plays: Grades 9-12
Literature: Grade 11				
History of Lit: Grades 9-12 Poetry Study: Grade 11	Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12	General Lit.: Grades 11-12 Poetry Study: Grade 11	Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12	General Lit.: Grades 11-12 Plays: Grades 9-12
Literature: Grade 12				
History of Lit: Grades 9-12		General Lit.: Grades 11-12	Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12	General Lit.: Grades 11-12 Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 Plays: Grades 9-12



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view

online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12

Poetry



The Aeneid



The Lightning Dreamer: Cuba's Greatest Abolitionist



Jump Back, Paul: The Life and Poems of Paul Laurence Dunbar



The Crescent Moon



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Related Course Quick Links

∞ [Foundations \(See Section 9: Literature\)](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12

How To Approach



Read

The lesson plans will guide you through what to read over the terms. Take a moment before reading to remember where you left off last time.



Narrate

The lesson plans will give you specific instructions or tell you to choose a way to narrate that helps you interact with the ideas.



Discuss

The lesson plans will guide you with questions or instructions to share your ideas or what you are reading with others.



Teacher Note

These lessons are written directly to students, but to assist them throughout the year, please read through this section and the lesson plans so you are familiar with the instructions and flow of the lessons. Accountability components are occasionally added to facilitate teacher/student discussion and growing independence.

It is also valuable for those in a classroom setting to have a mix of lessons that students complete themselves silently and others read aloud and narrate together. Literature lessons lend themselves well to a larger discussion time at the end of the lesson where student can share their ideas.

Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12

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Term 1

WEEK 1 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 1

Transition from Classicism to Romanticism

→ INTRO

Towards the end of the eighteenth century, writers were beginning to break from the rules of Classicism and experiment with poetic subject matter and form that, in retrospect, seem more aligned with the themes of Romanticism. Today, you will read a few works by three poets who bridge these two time periods: Thomas Gray, William Cowper, and Robert Burns.

→ READ & DISCUSS

∞ Link: *Elegy Written in a Country Churchyard*

- What is the setting of the poem, and how does Gray use this setting to create a mood or tone for the poem? What do you think the poet is saying about death and memory?

∞ Link: *The Shrubbery*

- How does the speaker show that there is a disconnect between how he feels and where he is? What is his relationship to the nature he sees around him?

∞ Link: *To a Mouse*

- If the language seems hard, try reading it out loud!
- This poem ends with a turn - why does the speaker see the mouse as "blest, compar'd wi' me!"?

WEEK 1 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 2

William Wordsworth

→ INTRO

We will learn more about William Wordsworth (1770-1850) in the History of Literature lesson next week, but today's reading should give you a feel for his style and major themes. As you read, compare Wordsworth's poem to the selections you read last time. "Tintern Abbey" is written in blank verse (unrhymed iambic pentameter, or ten syllables per line). What other poets have you read that use blank verse? How is this different than Gray's "Elegy" you read last week, that had a very rigid structure?

∞ Link: *Lines Composed a Few Miles above Tintern Abbey, On Revisiting the Banks of the Wye during a Tour. July 13, 1798*

- What are some images that especially stand out to you? What is Wordsworth saying about nature?
- What do you think he means when he says in lines 64-67: "here I stand, not only with the sense / Of present pleasure, but with pleasing thoughts / That in this moment there is life and food / For future years."?

→ VIEW

Look at this painting of Tintern Abbey painted in 1804 by English landscape painter William Havell (1782-1857).

WEEK 2 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 3

William Wordsworth and Samuel Taylor Coleridge

→ INTRO

With the anonymous publication in 1798 of their *Lyrical Ballads*, Wordsworth and Coleridge introduced a new style of poetry to the public. The initial publication received mixed reviews, however, and with each subsequent publication, the two poets included a Preface by way of an introduction to their style, themes, and purpose. In today's lesson, you will read excerpts from the 1802 edition of this preface, as well as a representative poem by each of them. Think about how the poetry you

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Term 1

read illustrates some of the points made in the Preface.

→ READ & DISCUSS

1. ∞ PDF Link: Excerpts from the Preface to the Lyrical Ballads (1802)

2. Wordsworth, "My Heart Leaps Up"

My heart leaps up when I behold

A rainbow in the sky:

So was it when my life began;

So is it now I am a man;

So be it when I shall grow old,

Or let me die!

The Child is father of the Man;

And I could wish my days to be

Bound each to each by natural piety.

3. ∞ Link: Wordsworth, "I Wandered Lonely As A Cloud"

4. ∞ Link: Coleridge, "The Rime of the Ancient Mariner"

• NOTE: This poem is too long to read completely today, but reading it for a few minutes will give you a feel for the style. If you enjoy it, please finish reading it during the next poetry class or during your free reading time!

WEEK 2 □ 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 4

Samuel Taylor Coleridge

→ INTRO

Today we are going to read a poem much different in style from The Rime of the Ancient Mariner. As you read, think about other poems you have read about children, or by poets remembering their own childhood.

∞ Link: Frost at Midnight

With any time remaining, you can read more of The Rime of the Ancient Mariner.

★ TEACHER TIP

There is a Poem Guide for Frost at Midnight at the Poetry Foundation link, if your student would like extra information about the poem or help with understanding it.

WEEK 3 □ 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 5

Rabindranath Tagore

□ Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ INTRO

We will spend much of Term 1 reading poems by the Bengali writer, philosopher and artist Rabindranath Tagore. He wrote in Bengali, but translated his own works into English. He is a significant figure for Indian nationalism, and, though not himself a politician, was a vocal proponent of India's independence at the turn of the twentieth century.

The Crescent Moon is a collection of forty poems exploring themes such as childhood wonder, the natural world, imagination. As you read through these poems, think about other poems you have read that present the world through the eyes of children, such as Robert Louis Stevenson's A Child's Garden of Verses.

→ READ & DISCUSS

Read one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.

p.6-7 "The Home"

• How would you describe the speaker of this poem?

• The poem opens with two examples of personification (a figure of speech which gives human characteristics to non-human things). Why do you think Tagore uses these images of a miser and a widow?

p.8 "On the Seashore"

★ TEACHER NOTE

If you are note taking the History of Lit 9-12 course, you may wish to watch this introduction to the life and work of Rabindranath Tagore during some free time.

∞ Video Link: Rabindranath Tagore – Mystic Poet, Literary Genius & Nobel Laureate

Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12

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Term 1

- What images stand out most to you in this poem? How might they be symbols of a deeper meaning that lies beneath a simple description of children playing?

p.9-10 "The Source" and "Baby's Way"

- What do these two poems together seem to say about the nature of infants and children?

WEEK 3 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 6

Rabindranath Tagore, cont.

Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ RECAP

What was your favorite poem by Tagore you read last time? What did you like most about it?

→ READ & DISCUSS

Read one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.

p.11-16

- What images stand out to you the most in today's poems?

WEEK 4 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 7

Rabindranath Tagore, cont.

Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ RECAP

What was your favorite poem by Tagore you read last time? What did you like most about it?

→ READ & DISCUSS

Read one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.

p.17-22

- What images stand out to you the most in today's poems?

WEEK 4 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 8

Rabindranath Tagore, cont.

Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ RECAP

What was your favorite poem by Tagore you read last time? What did you like most about it?

→ READ & DISCUSS

Read one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.

p.23-29

- What images stand out to you the most in today's poems?

WEEK 5 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 9

Rabindranath Tagore, cont.

Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ RECAP

What was your favorite poem by Tagore you read last time? What did you like most about it?

→ READ & DISCUSS

Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12

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Term 1

Read one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.

p.30-35

- What images stand out to you the most in today's poems?

WEEK 5 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 10

Percy Bysshe Shelley

→ INTRO

Today, we are turning our attention to the first of two second-generation Romantic poets: Percy Bysshe Shelley. While he was inspired by the work and thought of Wordsworth and Coleridge, he has a style all his own. Look for some of the themes you've been learning about from the Romantic Period.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. The first two poems are sonnets: what do you already know about sonnets? How does the form support the meaning of the poem? Both these poems have guides, if you would like to read about them further.

∞ Link: Ozymandias

∞ Link: England in 1819

- What do you know about what was happening in English around the year 1819?

2. In these second two poems, consider how Shelley is representing nature.

∞ Link: Ode to the West Wind

∞ Link: Mont Blanc

- What poetic images stand out to you the most?

WEEK 6 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 11

Rabindranath Tagore, cont.

Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ RECAP

What was your favorite poem by Shelley that you read in the last lesson?

What did you like most about it?

→ READ & DISCUSS

Read one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.

p.36-40

- What images stand out to you the most in today's poems?

WEEK 6 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 12

John Keats

→ INTRO

Today, we will meet the second of the second-generation Romantic poets: John Keats. As we did with Shelley, look for some of the themes you've been learning about from the Romantic Period. There is only one poem to read today, because your understanding and appreciation of it will increase with multiple readings. Read it through more than once on your own, and if you would like some interpretive help, there is a link to a Guide to the poem.

This poem, Ode on a Grecian Urn, is a famous example of ekphrasis, or the poetic descriptions of a work of art. As you read, think about how the poetry engages with other arts, such as sculpture and music. What does it have to say about the limits of any one art form, or, put more bluntly, what can poetry do that sculpture can't, and vice versa?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Link: Ode on a Grecian Urn

Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12

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Term 1

- The final enigmatic two lines have been an interpretive puzzle since Keats wrote this poem - what do you think he means by "Beauty is truth, truth beauty,—that is all / Ye know on earth, and all ye need to know." And why are they in quotation marks?

→ VIEW

It is helpful to have an image of what Keats is describing when reading the poem.

∞ Link: Sketch of an Urn by Keats

WEEK 7 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 13

Rabindranath Tagore, cont.

📄 Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ RECAP

What was your favorite poem by Tagore you read last time? What did you like most about it?

→ READ & DISCUSS

Read one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.
p.41-46

- What images stand out to you the most in today's poems?

WEEK 7 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 14

John Keats, cont.

→ RECAP

What was your favorite poem by Tagore you read last time? What did you like most about it?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. ∞ Link: Ode to a Nightingale

- What does the nightingale represent to Keats in this poem?

2. The other two poems by Keats are both sonnets written in response to other works of art. The first he wrote after reading George Chapman's translation of Homer, and the second in response to the Elgin Marbles (statuaries from the Parthenon) when they first were displayed at the British Museum.

∞ Link: On First Looking into Chapman's Homer

∞ Link: On Seeing the Elgin Marbles

→ VIEW

A slide show of the sculptures that Keats would have seen.

∞ Link: The Elgin Marbles at the British Library

• EXTRA HELPING

The Elgin Marbles are controversial, and Greece has requested their repatriation. Read more about the controversy here.

∞ Link: The Elgin Marbles

WEEK 8 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 15

Gertrudis Gómez de Avellaneda

→ INTRO

Today we will learn about a Romantic poet from another part of the world - Gertrudis Gómez de Avellaneda - who was born in Cuba and lived in Spain.

WEEK 8 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 16

Lightning Dreamer

WEEK 9 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 17

Lightening Dreamer

Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12

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Term 1

WEEK 9 ☐ 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 18

Rabindranath Tagore, cont.

☐ Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ RECAP

What was your favorite poem by Tagore you read last time? What did you like most about it?

→ READ & DISCUSS

Read one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.
p.47-50

- What images stand out to you the most in today's poems?

WEEK 10 ☐ 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 19

Lightening Dreamer

WEEK 10 ☐ 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 20

Rabindranath Tagore, cont.

☐ Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ RECAP

What was your favorite poem by Tagore you read last time? What did you like most about it?

→ READ & DISCUSS

Read one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.
p.51-54, anthems?

- What images stand out to you the most in today's poems?

WEEK 11 ☐ 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 21

Lightening Dreamer

WEEK 11 ☐ 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 22

Tagore - Fireflies

WEEK 12 ☐ 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 23

Exam

WEEK 12 ☐ 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 24

Exam

Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12

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Term 2	
WEEK 1	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 25
WEEK 1	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 26
WEEK 2	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 27
WEEK 2	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 28
WEEK 3	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 29
WEEK 3	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 30
WEEK 4	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 31
WEEK 4	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 32
WEEK 5	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 33
WEEK 5	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 34
WEEK 6	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 35
WEEK 6	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 36
WEEK 7	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 37
WEEK 7	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 38
WEEK 8	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 39
WEEK 8	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 40
WEEK 9	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 41
WEEK 9	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 42
WEEK 10	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 43
WEEK 10	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 44
WEEK 11	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 45
WEEK 11	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 46
WEEK 12	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 47
WEEK 12	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 48

Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12

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Term 3	
WEEK 1	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 49
WEEK 1	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 50
WEEK 2	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 51
WEEK 2	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 52
WEEK 3	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 53
WEEK 3	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 54
WEEK 4	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 55
WEEK 4	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 56
WEEK 5	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 57
WEEK 5	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 58
WEEK 6	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 59
WEEK 6	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 60
WEEK 7	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 61
WEEK 7	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 62
WEEK 8	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 63
WEEK 8	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 64
WEEK 9	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 65
WEEK 9	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 66
WEEK 10	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 67
WEEK 10	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 68
WEEK 11	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 69
WEEK 11	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 70
WEEK 12	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 71
WEEK 12	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 72